

mediated by money anxiety', published in the *Journal of Economic Psychology* in 2014,⁶ discusses the relationship between objective and subjective wealth – i.e. how much money we have vs how much money we think we have – and identifies money anxiety as one of the key influencers of a disconnect between the two. It also shows that there is a closer correlation between objective and subjective wealth – i.e. less risk of money dysmorphia – in people who have a high level of financial control and planning. These findings really hold true to the experiences that I've encountered, and is why developing a stronger connection to our finances, and forming rituals and habits around practices such as budgeting, are the red threads running through these five steps.

Exercise: Unpacking your financial past

This is a journaling exercise, and it could take a little while. Try to clear some space in your day, and sit in the calmest environment that you can find, then give yourself a blank piece of paper or a fresh page in a notebook. As you reflect on the topics raised in this section, I'd like you to think about how your own attitude towards money has been formed, and see if you can link anything together. You'll probably realize fairly quickly that any unhealthy elements in your relationship with money have been sparked by something in your past. As you journal this out, see if you can draw lines and arrows connecting them together. You might then want to summarize on a separate page, giving